Alex Berns

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Website: alexberns.github.io/berns
Citizenship: Germany

Experience

TSMC, Fab 24
CMP Equipment Engineer (starting April 2027) 2027–

SB Intuitions (SoftBank Group), Tokyo, Japan
Research Intern, Responsible AI Team 2026
AI Safety research on Japan's largest GPU cluster (until Dec 2026)

Feluwa Pumpen GmbH, Mürlenbach, Germany
Dual Study, Electrical Engineering (R&D) 2019–2024
Machine-learning model for fault diagnosis of double-hose membrane pumps
Mechatronics Technician (apprenticeship) 2019–2023
Switchgear, frequency converters & motors up to 1.2 MW; plant maintenance
Assembly of control panels & connection of sensor equipment

Trier University of Applied Sciences, Germany
Teaching Assistant, Undergraduate Mathematics 2021–2022

German–Chinese Society, Trier, Germany
Chinese Language & Cultural Assistant 2020–2023
Translation, interpreting & cultural exchange

Education

Tohoku University, Sendai, Japan
M.Sc. Computer Science 2024–2027
Advisor: Minoru Kuribayashi; Ito Foundation Full Scholarship (JPY 3.6M)
Also admitted to the Technical University of Munich (TUM)

Trier University of Applied Sciences, Germany
B.Eng. Electrical Engineering 2019–2024
GPA 3.4/4.0; thesis: ML for condition monitoring of membrane pumps

Berufsbildende Schule Wittlich, Germany
Certified Mechatronics Technician (IHK) 2019–2023
Recognized German dual-vocational qualification

Westlake Boys High School, New Zealand
Cambridge International A-Levels 2015–2019
A*A*A — Physics, German, Mathematics

Publications

Toxicity Lost in Translation: A Toxicity-Preserving Framework for LLM Safety Benchmarking
Berns, Huy, Pride, Wataoka — AAAI 2027, Montréal, Canada

Layer-Wise Weight Statistics for Node Classification and Defense of Federated Large Language Models
Berns, Akai, Kuribayashi — APSIPA ASC 2025, Singapore

Selected Awards

FunkenSprüher Innovation Award for academic thesis — 750 EUR 2024

German National Chinese Language Competition — 2nd place 2023

AFS Exchange Scholarship (New Zealand Government) — six months with a Chinese host family, attending high school in Yantai, Shandong 2018

Languages

German (native), English (native), Chinese (Mandarin, HSK 6), Japanese (JLPT N3)

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